

PRACTICAL REPORT

COURSE – BUSINESS ANALYTICS (UNIT 2)

PRACTICAL 5

**BUILD THE RETAILPULSE SALES PROMPT REPORT
USING IBM COGNOS ANALYTICS**

SUBMITTED BY

ARNAV MISHRA

BCA (DS & AI)

ROLL NO. – 1250258126

SCHOOL OF COMPUTER APPLICATIONS

BABU BANARASI DAS UNIVERSITY, LUCKNOW

ACADEMIC SESSION 2026–2027

1. AIM / OBJECTIVE

To design a prompt page with a value prompt, a date-range prompt and a cascading prompt, and to link each control to a report filter. Related topic: Design a Cognos Prompt Report for Sales Analysis.

2. MATERIALS REQUIRED

- IBM Cognos Analytics access.
- The RetailPulse Region-Product Crosstab report from Practical 4.

3. INTRODUCTION

A **prompt report** asks the user to choose values before the report runs, so one report can serve many questions instead of needing a separate version for each region or period. Prompts are placed on a **prompt page** that appears ahead of the report page.

A **value prompt** lets the user pick from a list of values, here Region. A **date-range prompt** collects a start and end date for the reporting period. A **cascading prompt** depends on an earlier prompt: the Store list is narrowed to the stores in the chosen Region, so the user cannot select a store that does not belong to it.

Each prompt control sets a **parameter**. A **filter** on the report query uses that parameter, so the crosstab returns only the data the user selected. **Default values** let the report run sensibly even when the user accepts the page as it is, and a **Finish button** submits the choices.

4. PROCEDURE

Step	Action
1	Open the RetailPulse Region-Product Crosstab report from Practical 4 in the report editor.
2	Insert a new prompt page ahead of the crosstab page (Page Explorer > Prompt Pages).
3	Add a Value prompt for Region and a Date prompt set as a range for the reporting period.
4	Add a Store value prompt and set its cascade source to the Region prompt so the list depends on the chosen Region.
5	Link each prompt to its matching filter on the crosstab query, using the prompt parameter in each filter.
6	Set default values, add a Finish button, then run and test the report end to end.

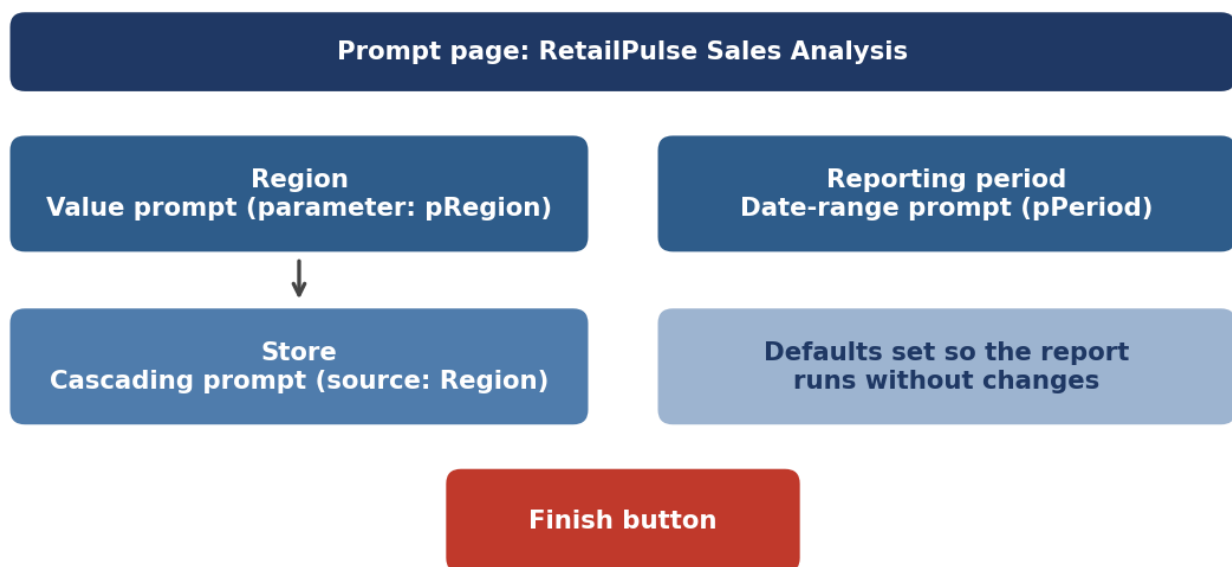
5. PROMPT CONFIGURATION

Parameter and item names below are examples. Use the names in your own report and package.

Control	Prompt type	Parameter (example)	Linked filter on crosstab (example)
Region	Value prompt	pRegion	[Region] in ?pRegion?
Reporting period	Date prompt, range	pPeriod	[Date] between ?pPeriod?
Store	Value prompt, cascading from Region	pStore	[Store Name] in ?pStore?

6. PLANNED PROMPT PAGE

Planned prompt page (schematic, not real output)



Region is chosen first because the Store list depends on it. Setting default values and marking the controls as needed makes the report run without extra input.

7. TESTING

The report is tested end to end by submitting the prompt page and checking that the crosstab matches the selections.

Test	Action	Expected result
1	Run with default values	Prompt page shows all three controls with sensible defaults; Finish returns a crosstab
2	Region = North, date range inside the current quarter	Crosstab shows only North and only dates within the range
3	Open the Store list	Only stores in North are listed
4	Change Region to South and submit again	Store list updates to South stores and the crosstab shows South results

8. EXPECTED OUTCOME AND OBSERVATIONS

The prompt page renders all three controls correctly; changing Region updates the Store list without error; submitting returns a correctly filtered crosstab; and default values produce a sensible report without any changes.

Check	Observed (tick after running)
Prompt page appears before the crosstab	☐
Region, date-range and Store controls all render	☐
Store list changes when Region changes, with no error	☐
Crosstab is filtered to the chosen Region and date range	☐
Default values give a sensible report with no changes	☐
Finish button submits the page	☐
Report saved	☐

9. CONCLUSION

In this practical a prompt page was added to the RetailPulse Region-Product Crosstab report in IBM Cognos Analytics. A value prompt for Region, a date-range prompt for the reporting period and a cascading Store prompt were linked to filters on the crosstab, so one report could answer questions for different regions, stores and periods. Default values and a Finish button made the report easy to run. The practical showed how prompts make a report flexible and reusable.

10. PRECAUTIONS

- Use the same parameter name in the prompt and in its filter, or the filter will not apply.
- Set the Store prompt's cascade source to the Region prompt.
- Check that the date filter uses the correct date item and range.
- Provide default values for every prompt that the report needs.
- Test with at least two regions to confirm the cascade and the filters.